

Windows Core OS to include open source components

Microsoft is becoming more open towards the open source community. The acquisition of GitHub has already validated its commitment towards the open source world. Now, the software giant is further increasing its focus on the open source ecosystem.

Going by the LinkedIn profile of a Security Program Manager II, the Windows Core OS is likely to rely even more on open source components. The profile reads: “Confidential program requiring machine learning/data science knowledge and program management skillset to ensure the security of Windows Core OS from malicious actors and code. Improved the security posture of Windows open source components through initiatives that investigate vulnerabilities found, and established a process for remediation. Improved the overall program management skillset, communication, and collaboration throughout the WDG IS organisation.”



Microsoft, under the leadership of Satya Nadella, is investing more and more in open source. 2018 was filled with big open source surprises from Microsoft. Last year, the company open sourced its patent portfolio and bought GitHub for US\$ 7.5 billion. It also joined the Open Invention Network (OIN), an open source patent consortium, and made its 60,000+ patents available.

In the same year, it added OpenSSH, Curl, and Tar support to Windows 10. More distributions were added to WSL (Windows Subsystem for Linux). Microsoft also open sourced a WSL sample to make it easier for other Linux distributions to ‘port’ to WSL and become available via the Microsoft Store.

Mapzen provides developers with open software and wide-ranging data sets that are customisable and easy to access. It was launched in 2013 by mapping industry veterans in combination with urban planners, architects, movie makers and video game developers.

With Mapzen, developers can take the open data and build vibrant maps



equipped with search and routing services, augment their own libraries, and also process data in real-time. It is used by organisations such as Snapchat, Foursquare, Mapbox, Eventbrite, the

World Bank, HERE Technologies, and Mapillary. This is not possible with other conventional mapping or geo-tracking services.

Randy Meech, former CEO of Mapzen and current CEO of StreetCred Labs, said, “Mapzen is excited to join the Linux Foundation and continue our open, collaborative approach to mapping software and data. Shared technology can be amazingly powerful, but also complex and challenging. The Linux Foundation knows how to enable collaboration across organisations and has a great reputation for hosting active, thriving software and data projects.”

Jim Zemlin, executive director at the Linux Foundation commented, “Mapzen’s open approach to software and data has allowed developers and businesses to create innovative location-based applications that have changed our lives. We look forward to extending Mapzen’s impact even further around the globe in areas like transportation and traffic management, entertainment, photography and more to create new value for companies and consumers.”

Mapzen’s open resources and projects are used by developers to create their own applications or integrate them into other products and platforms. As Mapzen’s resources are all open source, developers can easily build platforms of their liking without the restrictions of data sets put in place by other commercial providers.

Simon Willison, engineering director at Eventbrite, said, “We’ve been using ‘Who’s On First’ to help power Eventbrite’s new event discovery features since 2017. The gazetteer offers a unique geographical approach which allows us to innovate extensively with how our platform thinks about events and their locations. Mapzen is an amazing project and we’re delighted to see it joining the Linux Foundation.”

Matt Kamen, senior VP of engineering at Foursquare, also extended his support to Mapzen as it begins its new journey with the Linux Foundation. “We support Mapzen in its mission to offer open source geo-location technology for developers and organisations around the globe, and we’re happy to see that it has joined the Linux Foundation,” he said.

In addition to neutral governance, the Linux Foundation said it will align resources to advance Mapzen’s mission and further grow its ecosystem of users and developers.